

Self-MBA Master Learning Sheet (12-Month Plan)

Goal: Learn most practical knowledge typically gained during an MBA program while also developing real-world business thinking.

Time Commitment:

- Weekdays: 2–3 hrs/day
 - Weekends: 4–6 hrs/day
 - Total: ~20 hrs/week
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Daily Core Routine (Every Day)

Activity	Time
Read business/economy news	20 mins
Read 1 long-form article/case study	20 mins
Main learning topic	60–90 mins
Practice/project/application	30–60 mins
Notes/revision	15 mins

Daily Reading Sources

Business & Economy

- The Economist
- Mint
- Business Standard
- Harvard Business Review
- McKinsey Insights

Startup & Tech

- Y Combinator Essays
 - Paul Graham Essays
 - TechCrunch
 - Stratechery
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MONTH 1 — Business Foundations

Week 1 — Understanding Business

Day 1

- What is a business?
- Types of businesses
- Revenue vs profit
- Learn basic business terminology

Day 2

- Business models
- B2B vs B2C vs D2C
- Subscription models

Day 3

- How startups work
- MVP concept
- Product-market fit

Day 4

- Competitive advantage
- Moats
- Network effects

Day 5

- Unit economics
- CAC, LTV, margins

Day 6

- Analyze 3 successful startups
- Write business breakdown notes

Day 7

- Weekly revision
 - Create summary notes
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Week 2 — Economics Basics

Learn

- GDP
- Inflation
- Interest rates
- Fiscal policy
- Monetary policy
- Supply & demand
- Recession

Practice

- Explain economic news in simple language
 - Track RBI decisions
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Week 3 — Accounting Basics

Learn

- Balance sheet
- Income statement
- Cash flow statement
- Assets/liabilities
- Depreciation

Practice

- Read annual reports of companies
 - Analyze Apple/Tesla/TCS reports
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Week 4 — Corporate Finance Basics

Learn

- Time value of money
- NPV
- IRR
- Debt vs equity
- Valuation basics

Practice

- Simple company valuation exercises

MONTH 2 — Marketing Mastery

Week 1 — Consumer Psychology

Learn

- Why people buy
- Emotional triggers
- Positioning
- Branding

Practice

- Analyze ads from Nike/Apple/Zomato
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Week 2 — Digital Marketing

Learn

- SEO
- Social media marketing
- Funnels
- Paid ads
- Email marketing

Practice

- Create a fake marketing campaign
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Week 3 — Sales

Learn

- Sales psychology
- Negotiation
- B2B sales
- Cold outreach

Practice

- Write sales emails
 - Practice pitching
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Week 4 — Brand Building

Learn

- Brand identity
- Storytelling
- Community building

Practice

- Build a fake brand from scratch
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MONTH 3 — Strategy & Decision Making

Week 1

- SWOT analysis
- Porter's Five Forces
- Competitive analysis

Week 2

- Market entry strategies
- Pricing strategy
- Expansion strategies

Week 3

- Decision-making frameworks
- First principles thinking
- Risk analysis

Week 4

- Analyze strategies of Amazon, Netflix, Apple
 - Create strategy reports
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MONTH 4 — Operations & Systems

Learn

- Supply chain

- Lean systems
- Process optimization
- Inventory management
- Scaling operations
- SOP creation

Practice

- Design operations flow for an app/business
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MONTH 5 — Leadership & Communication

Week 1

- Public speaking
- Executive communication
- Business writing

Week 2

- Team management
- Delegation
- Conflict resolution

Week 3

- Negotiation
- Persuasion
- Stakeholder management

Week 4

- Mock presentations
 - Interview simulations
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MONTH 6 — Entrepreneurship

Week 1

- Startup ideation
- Identifying problems

Week 2

- MVP building
- Product validation

Week 3

- Fundraising
- Pitch decks
- Investor thinking

Week 4

- Build a startup plan
 - Create pitch presentation
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MONTH 7 — Analytics & Data

Learn

- Excel advanced
- SQL basics
- Power BI/Tableau
- KPIs & metrics
- A/B testing
- Data-driven decision making

Practice

- Build dashboards
 - Analyze datasets
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MONTH 8 — Product Management

Learn

- Product lifecycle
- User research
- Wireframing
- Roadmaps
- Prioritization frameworks

Practice

- Build PRDs
 - Analyze famous products
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MONTH 9 — AI, Tech & Business

Especially important for your background.

Learn

- AI business models
- SaaS economics
- AI agents
- Automation businesses
- API economy
- Platform businesses

Practice

- Create AI startup ideas
 - Analyze OpenAI, Cursor, Perplexity, Anthropic
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MONTH 10 — Real MBA Case Studies

Daily Work

- Solve one business case study daily
- Write solutions
- Present recommendations

Areas

- Finance cases
 - Marketing cases
 - Startup cases
 - Product cases
 - Operations cases
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MONTH 11 — Real-World Execution

Build Something

Choose one:

- Startup
- Consulting service
- SaaS product
- AI tool
- Agency

Goal: Apply everything learned.

MONTH 12 — Executive-Level Thinking

Learn

- Global markets
- Leadership psychology
- Organizational behavior
- Corporate politics
- Scale management
- Hiring systems
- Vision & culture building

Practice

- Read CEO interviews
 - Study shareholder letters
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Weekly Structure Template

Day	Focus
Monday	Learning concepts
Tuesday	Practice/application
Wednesday	Case study
Thursday	Deep learning

Day	Focus
Friday	Real-world analysis
Saturday	Projects/building
Sunday	Revision + notes

Essential MBA-Level Skills Checklist

Finance

- Read financial statements
- Understand valuation
- Budgeting
- Forecasting

Marketing

- Positioning
- Branding
- Consumer psychology
- Growth strategies

Leadership

- Communication
- Negotiation
- Team management

Strategy

- Competitive analysis
- Decision-making
- Market analysis

Entrepreneurship

- MVPs
- Fundraising
- Product-market fit

Analytics

- Excel

- SQL
 - Dashboards
 - Metrics
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Best Books (Read Throughout Year)

Business

- The Lean Startup
- Zero to One
- Good Strategy Bad Strategy
- Blue Ocean Strategy

Psychology

- Influence
- Thinking Fast and Slow
- Never Split the Difference

Finance

- The Intelligent Investor
- One Up On Wall Street

Leadership

- High Output Management
 - The First 90 Days
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Best Free MBA-Level Platforms

- MIT OpenCourseWare
 - Harvard Business Review
 - Stanford eCorner
 - Y Combinator Startup School
 - Coursera
 - HubSpot Academy
 - Google Digital Garage
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Final Goal After 12 Months

You should be able to:

- Understand businesses deeply
- Read markets intelligently
- Build and scale products
- Speak professionally
- Analyze financials
- Lead teams
- Think strategically
- Pitch ideas confidently
- Operate like a startup founder/product leader

This path combined with your technical skills can become more valuable than a traditional MBA if applied consistently in real projects.